

Andhra Pradesh: Building a Global Talent Capital for the 21st Century

Andhra Pradesh is advancing a transformative human capital agenda, embedding education, skills, and workforce readiness into its growth strategy. By 2029, the state envisions a globally benchmarked lifelong learning ecosystem that integrates schooling, higher education, industry linkages, and global labour markets—positioning Andhra Pradesh as a strategic partner for sustainable economic development.

Learning Excellence in Andhra Pradesh (LEAP) anchors the state's talent strategy, aligning education with National Education Policy 2020 to build a unified human capital pipeline. Key reforms include early skill exposure from Class 6, reaching 3.2 lakh students across 1,599 schools with vocational infrastructure and trained instructors; National Skills Qualifications Framework-aligned vocational education in 744 junior colleges for 93,000 students, embedding 100% on-the-job training; industry-linked technical education via ITIs and polytechnics, achieving 98% seat utilisation and 94.6% placement rates; curriculum modernisation introducing AI, digital literacy, and problem-solving skills; and AI-driven governance to monitor learning outcomes and institutional performance.

As Hon'ble Minister for IT, Electronics, Communications, Human Resources Development & Skill Development Shri Nara Lokesh has noted in policy forums, education reform in Andhra Pradesh is no longer about expanding access alone, but about ensuring global relevance, employability, and lifelong adaptability.

Market-driven Skilling Partnerships

Building on LEAP, Andhra Pradesh has developed a market-driven skilling architecture aligned with industry demand. Partnerships with Microsoft, Oracle, Infosys, and Suzlon will train 300,000 youth in AI and cloud computing within a year, prioritising rural talent. Beyond digital skilling, institutions are aligned with clusters in electronics, green energy, logistics, aquaculture, IT, MedTech, and



manufacturing through 83 Government ITIs with 169 industry MoUs, CSR-supported advanced labs by Siemens, Schneider Electric, Mahindra & Mahindra, and others, and structured apprenticeships and internships integrated into pathways. According to the Hon'ble Minister, training institutions must function as extensions of industry ecosystems rather than isolated campuses—a principle now embedded across Andhra Pradesh's skilling reforms.

AI-powered Talent Platform

Naipunyam, an AI-powered unified platform, manages the entire talent lifecycle—counselling, training, certification, and placement. It integrates AI career guidance, Aadhaar/DigiLocker-linked credentials, QR-enabled certificates, and employer dashboards, consolidating millions of records for transparency and scale. As Shri Nara Lokesh affirms, Naipunyam will connect skill centres, integrate training and credentialing, and align job categories across 36 sectors—creating a seamless, industry-driven talent pipeline for workplace readiness at scale. The state is building international workforce pipelines through overseas career programmes for 22,500 youth; German-language training for 2,300 nursing students, of whom 55 achieved B2 proficiency; and high-value placements in Japan, Europe, and the GCC with packages up to ₹20 lakh. Andhra Pradesh is emerging as a trusted

source of globally competitive talent. Global technology leaders view Andhra Pradesh's policy-driven talent strategy as a key enabler of investment. Infosys underscores the state's focus on industry-aligned digital skilling, strong academic foundations, and scalable ecosystems. Its partnership reflects confidence in Andhra Pradesh's ability to deliver job-ready, globally competitive talent through stable policy and digital governance.

Andhra Pradesh is building strategic alliances with global technology leaders to equip youth for emerging technologies and global careers. A landmark partnership with NVIDIA has launched India's first AI University in Amaravati and trained 10,000 engineering students, positioning the state as a national AI talent hub. As Hon'ble Minister Shri Nara Lokesh emphasizes, "By equipping 10,000 students with cutting-edge AI skills and supporting our startup ecosystem, we are laying the foundation for a future-ready economy driven by innovation, research, and entrepreneurship."

In parallel, collaborations with Oracle deliver advanced skilling in cloud computing, cybersecurity, and data management to 50,000 students, while quantum computing programmes through WISER introduce research-led curricula and labs. Coupled with international mobility initiatives, these efforts reinforce Andhra Pradesh's vision of becoming a technology-driven innovation powerhouse.